

SkillVerse Research

Screen2Skill 2026

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The Rise of Self-Directed Learning

How Online Platforms Are Reshaping Education

Introduction

The traditional classroom is no longer the sole source of education. This report examines how 150+ teenagers acquire skills through online platforms, often outside formal education.

Top Learning Platforms

YouTube (82%), Khan Academy (34%), Coursera (18%), Udemy (15%), Discord communities (28%), Reddit (19%), GitHub (12%), Duolingo (24%). Most students use 3-4 platforms regularly.

Skills Self-Taught

Top skills learned online: Coding (43%), Video Editing (38%), Graphic Design (29%), Music Production (14%), Language Learning (22%), Photography (18%), 3D Modeling (8%), AI Prompting (35%).

Why Self-Directed?

71% say they learn at their own pace. 64% say content is more engaging. 52% say school doesn't teach what they want to learn. 45% say they can explore interests deeply.